AUGUSTA
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September 2, 2026

Alexander A. Schwarzmann, PhD,
Dean of the School of Computer and Cyber Sciences

Subject: Tenure and promotion evaluation of Dr. Williams

Dear Dean Schwarzmann,

The Promotion and Tenure Committee of the Department of Information Systems & Security (ISS) has examined the record of Assistant Professor Dr. Jason Williams, who has been on the tenure track at Augusta University since August 2020. Dr. Williams' workload allocation has emphasized research, with 55% research, 35% teaching, and 10% service.

The Committee carefully evaluated Dr. Williams' record of accomplishments and determined that he has met the expectations of the tenure-track position. After reviewing his contributions in research, teaching, service, student success, and professional development, the Committee unanimously recommends him for tenure and promotion.

Evaluation Rubric

At the time of Dr. William's appointment the school was influx and growing. In 2021, an official Information Systems & Security Promotion and Tenure Policy was adopted, but since then several revisions have occurred. Since Dr. Williams' appointment was closest to the 2021 policy, we as a committee used that years policy as our rubric for Dr. Williams' evaluation.

Teaching / Mentoring

Over the last six years Dr. Williams has taught a number of courses including: AIST 4720 (Enterprise System Architectures), AIST 6357 (Information Risk Management), AIST 7110 (Qualitative Research Methods in Information Systems), AIST 6365 (Information Security

Project Management), and CYBR 2600 (Introduction to Networking and Cyber Security). One point that is clear from the evidence provided by Dr. Williams is that he has actively pursued improvements in his pedagogy, classroom management, and lecturing. His course evaluations, with a mean response rate of 64.2% and mean quantitative scores between 4 and 5 the last three years and 3 and 5 the first three years of his tenure, show improvements in all of these areas, and they make clear that he has continually improved each year. He adds real-world experience by introducing his students to applications such as Microsoft Azure and SimpleRisk. In addition, he uses modern teaching methods such as the flipped classroom, debate style group activities, and project-based learning to enhance the learning experience for his students. Lastly, all of the above is echoed by his peer reviewer who note the following in their feedback:

- Dr. Williams demonstrates strong subject-matter expertise and explains difficult concepts clearly, using historical context, recent research, examples, metaphors, figures, flowcharts, and other visuals effectively.
- Dr. Williams actively engages students through frequent participation, varied questioning techniques, discussion, coding exercises, and integration of material from previous weeks.
- The classroom environment is participatory and conducive to critical thinking, with appropriate pauses and opportunities for group discussion.
- Presentation quality is strong: slides are clear, well structured, easy to see, and supported by effective use of projection and visual materials.
- Self-paced/asynchronous course modules are particularly well organized, with schedules, instructions, goals, assessments, and milestones clearly communicated.

Research / Scholarship

Dr. Williams meets the standards for outstanding scholarship. The quality of the his papers are exceptional, rising citations to recent papers are a signal of impact, and the Dr. Williams' ongoing work suggests a continuation and increase in research production and impact. He has been awarded $3k in internal grants with AU, and have several proposals under review. Based

on the current evidence we believe Dr. Williams' research will grow and he will eventually secure external funding. Furthermore, Dr. Williams has served on many program committees to conferences/workshops and as a referee to several journals.

The quality of Dr. Williams journal publications, 6 since 2022, is noteworthy. Based on the ABDC journal rating 4/6 papers are in A venues, 1 in a C venue, and 1 in a SCImago rated 2 venue. Furthermore, his two latest publications from 2025 already have 5 or more citations. This is an uncommon occurrence. It typically takes more time for papers to begin accumulating citations. This shows that he is targeting high-quality venues and publishing research that is of interest to the wider Information Systems community. Dr. Williams has also published at various conferences (~14 contributions) showing a high-level of engagement with the research community. Lastly, he has several works in progress which when combined with his past record shows that he will continue with is current research momentum.

Finally, Dr. Williams has shown a commitment to student mentorship by mentoring a PhD student, working with other graduate research assistants at both the PhD and master's level, and working with undergraduate research assistants. Several of his projects with students have resulted in publications.

Service

Dr. Williams meets the service requirements for the tenure and promotion. He served on various university and school level committees. In addition, he has served as a program committee member on various workshops and conferences, and as a reviewer for several conferences and journals. This shows a commitment to service to the profession as well as to the university community.

Some noteworthy roles within his profession are:

- member to the ACM Global Engagement Board;
- member of the conference leadership team for the ACM SIGMIS CPR Conference; and
- holding several roles for the International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), the top conference in Information Systems.

and some noteworthy university, school, and department service roles are:

- making significant contribution to the implementation of the behavioral track in the SCCS PhD Program;
- SLO Lead for the BSIT program during the 2021-2022 academic year;
- member of the Web Oversight Committee a number of times; and
- member of the faculty search committee.

All of these amount to an outstanding commitment to service.

Student Success Activities

Dr. Williams has shown a true to commitment to student success that should be commended. He has been advising a PhD student, Ron Martin, resulting in publications as well as mentoring him through a successful application to the ACM SIGMIS CPR 2026 Doctoral Consortium. He also served on the doctoral committee for another PhD student, Tal Lavi. Dr. Williams also proved a three-semester research internship to a graduate student that resulted in co-authored publication. Finally, he has worked with a large number of undergraduate students, as well as being an active member of the Undergraduate Honors Committee.

A noteworthy contribution is his inclusion of students in real research. He included IRB-approved research projects in his AIST 7110 (Qualitative Research Course) that resulted in a join publication. In addition, he received a $2k Education Innovation Fund (EIF) grant to provide his students with the necessary credits to make use of the Microsoft Azure platform.

Dr. Williams has served on the AU General Scholarship Review Committee (2023–2025), mentored fellow colleagues through their first-time teaching duties, as well as presented at local high schools. This is a direct contribution to service and partnerships for student support.

Professional Growth and Development

Dr. Williams has invested significant time in expanding his knowledge as an both a research and instructor:

- He earned the AU Online Teaching Certificate. He then used this new knowledge to

improve his graduate courses.

- He completed the Provost's Learning Community on the Implications of Cognitive Science Research for Teaching and Learning.
- Awarded a $1k travel grant by the Centers of Academic Excellence in Cybersecurity (CAE)—administered by the National Security Agency. He used this to attend a workshop on offensive security and penetration testing at San Antonio College.
- Became an AU Online (AUO) Certified Instructor in 2024. He then used this to improve several courses.
- Earned several CII Microcredentials in areas such as accessibility, usability, multimedia learning, assessment, and course facilitation.
- Attended several NSF grant writing seminars.
- Attend a virtual conference on Advanced PLS-SEM Topics.
- Attended MIS Quarterly editorial board seminars in Qualitative Methodologies (2022), Quantitative Causality (2022), and Behavioral Research Orientations (2023).
- Completed a multi-course certificate through the Office of Institutional Access, Success, and Belonging, having finished courses in Emotional Intelligence, Belonging and Winning Teams, and International Workplace Dynamics.
- Successfully renewed my Project Management Professional (PMP) certification in 2025; required 35 hours of professional education.
- Became a certified QPR Gatekeeper (2024); trained in crisis intervention and suicide prevention.
- Served as an Undergraduate Research and Fine Arts (URFA) conference judge (2025).
- Faculty Advisor on the Testing and Disability Services (TDS) Advisory Committee.

These clearly show a commitment to professional growth.

Letters of External Reviewers

In total, 9 external reviewers submitted letters that unanimously agree that Dr. Williams is an accomplished scholar and teacher. Every reviewer highlighted the strength of Dr. Williams' journal publications and commitment to teaching and professional development through innovative methods and continuing education.

The following are summaries of the noteworthy points made by each external reviewer:

1. This letter made it clear that Dr. Williams has developed a coherent and productive research program with a clear scholarly identity focused on how individuals and organizations use, misuse, evaluate, and respond to information technologies. In addition, the reviewer states that Dr. Williams' research addresses topical, theoretically meaningful, and socially consequential challenges that are increasingly important to organizations and society.

2. This letter notes that Dr. Williams's file is strong, and his promotion and tenure are supported without reservation. Then go on to say that his publications and research activities form a coherent program rather than a collection of unrelated projects, and his citation trajectory is encouraging, increasing from single-digit annual citations early in his career to more than 20 per year by 2025, suggesting growing recognition of his recent work.

3. This letter reinforces the others by saying that Dr. Williams has developed a strong, active, and coherent research program characterized by sustained productivity, continued engagement with the Information Systems community, and a healthy research pipeline. They point out that a particular strength is his focus on developing and evaluating interventions that address consequential problems in cybersecurity, information quality, and decision-making, connecting rigorous scholarship with issues of importance to organizations and society and positioning his work to contribute to both research and practice.

4. The reviewer of this letter was impressed by Dr. Williams' research record for his

career stage. They state that it appears well positioned for sustained success as a researcher, and his recent productivity, strong research pipeline, and invited presentations demonstrate both continuing scholarly activity and recognized expertise within his research stream.

5. This reviewer echos the previous writers, but points out that Dr. Williams' 19 conference presentations and proceedings further demonstrate extensive engagement with the field and active development of his research program.

6. This letter highlights that collectively, Dr. Williams' research moves beyond technical solutions to examine how individuals interpret, evaluate, and act on information, establishing him as an agile scholar addressing important IT-related issues with research quality appropriate to his publication venues.

7. This letter emphasizes that Dr. Williams' scholarship demonstrates both sustained productivity and intellectual development, while its growing influence beyond his home institution indicates an expanding professional reputation and trajectory.

8. This letter highlights that Dr. Williams' authorship record demonstrates that he drives many of his research projects, while his clearly defined and interconnected research streams provide evidence of a coherent agenda and a strong foundation for continued productivity.

9. Finally, this letter points out that Dr. Williams has an impressive publication record, his Best Paper Award nominations, competitive acceptance at selective conferences, ambitious grant-seeking efforts, and interdisciplinary collaborations further strengthen his record. Taken together, these accomplishments demonstrate a distinct and accelerating research trajectory that compares favorably with successful tenure candidates in Information Systems and meets the SCCS standard for outstanding scholarship.

All letter writers state that Dr. Williams has a strong commitment to teaching excellence. This is demonstrated through instructional innovation, the use of evidence-based pedagogy, and his continued education. Through the noticeable improvements made throughout his

years teaching it is clear he cares deeply about his students success.

Sincerely,

The Promotion and Tenure Committee of the School of Computer and Cyber Sciences

Dr. Harley Eades (chair) **Dr. Stephen Flowerday** **Dr. John Heslen**